

it remains on the whole probable. The debt, if acknowledged, is small enough.

The greatest innovation of post-exilic Judaism was, of course, the doctrine of Immortality. Here again the stimulus of Parsism has been freely assumed. But if my thesis is right, the immortality doctrine of Magians in contact with Israel was very different from Zarathushtra's teaching. The bare fact that the Persians believed death would at last be abolished was not a very powerful encouragement to Jewish thinkers in their great venture; though I would not deny that it may have contributed something. The real lesson lies much deeper, and with it we may close, making no attempt to pursue parallels which only become numerous or detailed in a period outside our limits. Zarathushtra's doctrine of Immortality rested on a pure and passionate belief in the justice of God. Successors endowed with his spirit might have developed a serious theology recognising adequately the fact of sin and the need of deliverance. But the successors never came. Zarathushtra is a lonely figure, and the mere fact that Israel has a "goodly fellowship" of prophets to set against his solitariness is quite enough to explain the sequel. We might compare him with individuals in the long line and gladly count him worthy to stand among the greatest of them. But had he stood out above them all, he could not have prepared for the establishment of a world religion. It was Carthage that accounted for the failure of Hannibal: it was Iran that made Zarathushtra a voice of one crying in the wilderness where but few could hear. The interpreters of Zarathushtra busied themselves with